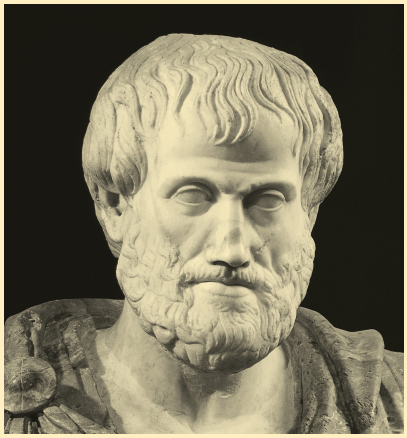
Aristotle



Aristotle was born in Macedonia, ancient Greece. Both his parents died when he was young, and he was raised by a guardian. Aged 17 or 18, Aristotle joined Plato's Academy in Athens, where he studied for 20 years, writing on physics, biology, zoology, politics, economics, government, poetry, and music. Later, he traveled to the island of Lesvos with a student named Theophrastus to study the island's botany and zoology. Much of his *History of Animals* was based on observations he made there. Aristotle taught both the future scholar Ptolemy and King Alexander the Great. In 335 BCE, he established his own school at the Lyceum in Athens. After Alexander's death in 322 BCE, Aristotle fled the city, and died on the island of Euboea in the same year.

Key works

4th century BCE

History of Animals

On the Parts of Animals

On the Generation of Animals

On the Movement of Animals

On the Progression of Animals

See also: The microbiological environment • A system for identifying all nature's organisms • Biological species concept • Microbiology • Animal behavior • Island biogeography